

Muncie Redevelopment Commission Meeting January 16th 2025

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hBd6vPEjdsY
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Target Category	muncie_city

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Muncie Redevelopment Commission Meeting Summary

Meeting Date: January 16, 2025

Governing Body: Muncie Redevelopment Commission (MRC)

2. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** **00:00:21** President Miller called the Muncie Redevelopment Commission meeting for January 16, 2025, to order.
- **Attendance:**
 - **Members Present:** Mr. Bishop (Vice President), Mr. Dale, Mr. Miller (President), Mr. Pabila (Secretary), and Miss Wagley.
 - **Members Absent:** None explicitly noted.
 - **Other Officials Present:** Mr. Low (in audience/board member representation), Mr. Wright (Director/Staff), Patty Goddard (HR Director), Mayor, Vicki (Muncie Downtown Development Partnership), and Mr. Freeman (City Attorney).

3. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** 00:00:21 Roll call and immediate opening of nominations for officers.
- **Election of Officers:** 00:00:27
 - **President:** Mr. Miller nominated himself (Approved by Voice Vote).
 - **Vice President:** Mr. Bishop nominated by President Miller (Approved by Voice Vote).
 - **Secretary:** Mr. Pabila nominated by President Miller; Mr. Dale self-nominated due to concerns regarding meeting minutes completeness.
 - **Roll Call Vote for Secretary:** Mr. Bishop voted for Dale; Mr. Dale voted for Dale; Mr. Miller voted for Pabila; Mr. Pabila voted for Pabila; Miss Wagley voted for Pabila. Mr. Pabila assumed the office of Secretary.
- **Approval of Agenda:** 00:02:18 Motion to approve the provided agenda.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Passed Unanimously by Roll Call Vote.
- **Approval of Minutes / Meeting Memoranda:** 00:02:42 Mr. Dale moved to table the prior meeting minutes, citing 13 to 20 consequential missing items and a major correction based on video review. The motion died for lack of a second 00:03:59. A subsequent motion to approve the meeting memoranda was made and seconded 00:04:01.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved with Mr. Dale voting "No" and all other members voting "Yes" 00:04:04.

4. Substantive Business & Board Action

- **00:04:16 Claims Review and Approval**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Craig Wright
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Mr. Wright presented the claims list, noting beginning-of-the-year bond payments. Mr. Dale questioned a utility bill for the former YMCA building (noted as invoiced to the new owner) and raised concerns regarding a \$21,000 payment to EMB Paving for work at Wiltshire. Mr. Dale noted the commission had previously voted to hold this payment until further information was provided, but staff went ahead and paid it based on 2023 agreements and street department approval. Mr. Dale criticized the process as a lack of diligence and proper procedure for claims approval. Mr. Wright explained that claims represent payments required by statute and time-sensitive operational obligations.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Motion to approve claims as presented passed unanimously by roll call vote 00:09:20.
- **00:09:34 Annual Ethics and Conflict of Interest Training**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Patty Goddard, HR Director
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Ms. Goddard delivered the annual mandatory conflict of interest training for city boards and commissions. She reviewed legal obligations, rules regarding gifts, honoraria, moonlighting, conflicts of interest in decisions/votes

and contracts, additional compensation, bribery, confidential information, use of city property, and political activity. Board members were instructed to complete disclosure forms and return them no later than Wednesday of the following week.

- **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Informational presentation; no formal board action required.
- **00:28:51 Presentation: Muncie Community Revitalization Grant Program (Facade Program)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** The Mayor & Jeff
 - **Deliberation Summary:** The Mayor proposed utilizing \$150,000 per year over the next 10 years (totaling \$1.5 million) from funds freed up by the payoff of a 10-year-old facade grant bond in December 2024. The program focuses on three areas: (1) Rehabilitation Grants for downtown exterior/structural restoration (up to \$25,000 match, 50% max); (2) Curb Appeal Grants for exterior improvements in neighborhoods outside downtown (up to \$15,000 match, 50% max); and (3) Dilapidated Structure Grants for partial/complete demolition and infill (up to \$10,000 to \$15,000). A 5-member committee (2 MRC members, 3 public members) will review applications. Board members discussed the distribution percentages, geographic focus areas, and whether a bond approach would provide faster, more robust results.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Discussed in conjunction with the comprehensive funding request below.
- **00:52:19 Overall Funding Request & Budget Allocations**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Jeff
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Staff presented a funding plan utilizing \$1.4 million recovered from a default on an economic development agreement (Southway Plaza) and \$150,000 from the retired bond proceeds. Proposed uses included: Air Park road resurfacing materials (\$500,000), parking lot purchase for downtown development (\$130,000), payoff of debt on the Indiana stamping property (\$400,000), street department paving support (\$250,000), contribution to new fire station debt service (\$250,000), and year-one funding for the facade grant program (\$150,000) totaling \$1,650,000 in uses. Mr. Dale and Mr. Bishop expressed concern over lack of advance notice to review figures and questioned spending MRC funds on general street paving outside targeted MRC mission areas. A motion to table the request failed (3-2).
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved 3-2 by roll call vote (Mr. Miller, Mr. Pabila, and Miss Wagley voting "Yes"; Mr. Bishop and Mr. Dale voting "No") **00:14:01**.
- **[00:14:46 / 01:14:35] Muncie Downtown Development Partnership Contract Extension**

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Vicki, Muncie Downtown Development Partnership
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Vicki presented an annual update on downtown statistics, events (including "Fire Up Downtown" generating approx. \$58,000 in economic impact), marketing campaigns, and database resources. She requested a contract extension. Board members discussed the need for an itemized budget outlining how the \$80,000 annual compensation is allocated. Clarification was provided regarding termination clauses (mutual agreement vs. 180-day notice for convenience).
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Motion to approve the contract extension for \$80,000 per year for two years, with the addition of a required budget expenditure outline, Approved by Voice Vote [01:31:00](#).
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5. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

- [01:31:38](#) **Charlie Jameson:** Addressed the commission regarding concerns over the demolition component of the proposed revitalization grant, urging that demolition be kept as an absolute last resort to preserve urban density. He also supported funding the paving of Air Park roads, noting heavy equipment and essential services utilization out there, and expressed interest in serving on the facade grant committee.
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6. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:** The next regular meeting is scheduled for February 20, 2025.
 - **Adjournment:** [01:37:21](#) The meeting was officially adjourned following closing board remarks.
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